

Education

Current or most recent secondary school

Canyon High School, 1510 N Interstate 35, New Braunfels, TX, USA, Public, CEEB: 445053 (08/2020 - 06/2024)

Progression	No change in progression
Graduation Date	06/2024

Colleges & universities

School	University of Texas at Austin, 2400 Inner Campus Drive, Austin, TX, USA, CEEB: 6882 Dual enrollment with high school, Credit awarded directly by college (08/2022 - 05/2023)
--------	--

Grades

Rank	2 / 518, Weighted
GPA	4.0 / 4, Unweighted

Current or most recent year courses

First semester

ART - Concert Band IV - (REG)
CHEM - AP Chemistry - (AP)
CALC - AP Calculus BC - (AP)
ENG - AP English Literature - (AP)
COMPSCI - UT Onramps Computer Science - (DUAL)
HIST - AP United States Government and Politics - (AP)

OTH/ELE - AP Seminar - (AP)

Second semester

ART - Concert Band IV - (REG)
CHEM - AP Chemistry - (AP)
CALC - AP Calculus BC - (AP)
ENG - AP English Literature - (AP)
COMPSCI - UT Onramps Computer Science - (DUAL)

HIST - AP Macroeconomics - (AP)
OTH/ELE - AP Seminar - (AP)

Honors

2024 YoungArts Winner With Distinction: Classical Music	National	12
---	----------	----

Texas Music Educators Association All-State Band: 6A Percussion, 1st Chair Best in State 2023	State/Regional	10, 11
University Interscholastic League Texas State Solo and Ensemble Contest Outstanding Performer	State/Regional	10, 11
National Hispanic Recognition Program	National	10
Ben Hardy "Outstanding Cougar" Award	School	11

Future plans

Other, Cognitive Musicologist, Doctorate

Testing

There is not yet any information to display on this page.

Copyright @Rakhimoff_Amir

Activities

Music: Instrumental

9, 10, 11, 12 School 8 hr/wk, 15 wk/yr Continue	Band President, 2x Drumline Captain (11, 12), Canyon High School Marching Band Directed communication between 4 band classes (200+ members), led half-time performances/pep rallies, pioneered fundraising efforts and social events
--	--

Community Service (Volunteer)

10, 11, 12 School 3 hr/wk, 27 wk/yr Continue	2x Secretary (11, 12), Key Club International Raised \$10k for Food4kids through charity concert with 10 participating local bands, documented meeting minutes/goals, recorded club attendance
---	--

Student Govt./Politics

11, 12 Year 2 hr/wk, 27 wk/yr Continue	2x Student Body Class Vice President, Canyon High School Student Council Orchestrated fundraising totaling >\$1k for class, coordinated senior trip/senior dinner, hosted pre-school year event with >120 student turnout
---	---

Community Service (Volunteer)

10, 11, 12 Year 2 hr/wk, 36 wk/yr Continue	President, National Honor Society Issued signatures authenticating 211 members' volunteering, formulated weekly agenda, catalogued service hour forms through an online database
---	--

Music: Instrumental

9, 10, 11, 12 School 4 hr/wk, 27 wk/yr Continue	2x Lead Pan Section Leader (11, 12), Canyon High School Steel Band Provided entertainment at town's annual Tree Lighting, Wassailfest, and private events (450+ attendees), promoted band program at 7 elementary schools
--	---

Music: Instrumental

9, 10, 11, 12
School
5 hr/wk, 36 wk/yr
Continue

3x Percussion Section Leader (10, 11, 12), Canyon High School Wind Ensemble
3-year UIL sweepstakes, 4-year varsity member, conducted student-ran sectionals in preparation for 7 concerts, repaired keyboard/accessory instruments

Music: Instrumental

9, 10, 11, 12
School
6 hr/wk, 18 wk/yr
Continue

Member, Canyon High School Percussion Ensemble
Performed chamber/pop/Latin music in annual Night of Percussion attracting 800 attendees across neighboring towns in collaboration with guest artists

Work (Paid)

11, 12
Break
8 hr/wk, 6 wk/yr
Continue

Member, Mariachi Clasico
Played vihuela for funerals, parties, church services/masses, and holiday events in the greater Austin area

Work (Paid)

11, 12
School
6 hr/wk, 9 wk/yr
Continue

Percussion Teacher, Private Lessons
Instructed 6 beginning to advanced students 1-hr lessons on ensemble music/technique, assigned individualized skill-appropriate repertoire/exercises

Science/Math

10, 11, 12
School
1.5 hr/wk, 36 wk/yr
Continue

Member, University Interscholastic League Academics - Calculator Applications
2nd place team in UIL Region, doubled # of club participants through ad campaign, analyzed engineering-focused problems, participated in TMSCA meet

Writing

Personal essay

Some students have a background, identity, interest, or talent that is so meaningful they believe their application would be incomplete without it. If this sounds like you, then please share your story.

With its hammered sides forged from bronze, the triangle gleamed in the fluorescent lights as he dangled it from a thin, crimson string knotted tightly into a neat loop.

"So, who wants to be embarrassed?" Instantly, my hand cut through the air above me- being 1484 miles away in Interlochen, Michigan and the farthest I'd ever been from home, there was no way I wasn't going to endure some discomfort. Mr. Aleo's grin settled as he handed me the cold triangle. "Five notes. I'm the conductor, and I want you to play on beat one. And, I want them to sound the same. *EXACTLY* the same."

Easy enough, I thought.

"One more thing. Your dynamic? *Pianissimo*."

My dad's voice echoed in my mind as I raised the triangle to eye level- *Strike in the same spot, same angle, same force. Only softer this time.*

In one sweeping motion, his palms rebounded in the air as if bouncing them from an invisible trampoline. Simultaneously, I struck the triangle from only millimeters away, aiming for the softest sound possible. Overtones showered the room, decaying in volume with every collision as they sprung off the newly painted white walls. However, adjusting my grip on the string, I tapped the triangle again with an unexpected force. The second note shattered the delicate silence of the room, my ears alerting me instantly of my musical error; not even the first two notes were close in volume. The triangle, funny enough, was a more challenging instrument than I thought.

Like the triangle, I too embrace inconsistency. Wearing mismatched socks is no problem- after all, no one can see different logos under my favorite corduroy pants. I handpick every leaflet of cilantro out of my *taco de barbacoa*, but I'll never turn down fresh *pico de gallo* salsa. Talking to my 4'11" *abuelita*, I incorporate words from Spanish and English in the same sentence as I see fit; the grammar rules of one language feel less restricting if you mix them with another.

Yet, despite my love for inconsistency, the other half of me indulges in uniformity. Being raised in a household of musicians, I flinch at the sound of wrong notes in a performance and out-of-tune instruments, all the while acknowledging the formulaic nature of the music theory underlying my favorite pop music which ensures that (almost) every Bruno Mars song resolves in a typical V-I perfect cadence.

Angular and astute, the triangle's tone shines brilliantly up close, yet blends harmoniously in the background when played punctually from afar. Similarly, the triangle's versatility of sound mirrors my diverse academic interests. When muted, its sound is short and direct, much like the sound of buttons on my Ti-Nspire CX-II T CAS calculator as I calculate how many minutes past the time 9:12 the minute and hour hands line up on an analogue clock. The resonance of its open tone is

strikingly similar to my long chains of thought as I dive deeply into Feynman's theories on the behavior of light, googling unfamiliar physics terms like "cathode ray tube" upon every puzzling encounter.

Much like the triangle, I embrace the irregularity of my actions as I navigate though the world. The carefully constructed melodies in my lime-green manuscript spiral are portraits of my musical journey; contrarily, my best jazz-vibraphone improvisations are merely the result of thoughtless muscle-memory combinations. I cling to my brother at every family *fiesta*, but I admit that my best conversations have all begun with chance encounters with strangers in the fruit aisle of H.E.B.

The versatility of something as simple as a triangle excites me; its many different sounds and required techniques create endless possibilities of creativity with every "ting." Stepping into a new chapter of my life, I'll embody the three-sided figure's precise sound with every ripple of my creative influence- I'll resonate with the world at volumes louder than just *pianissimo*.

Education progression

Details

Education progression details No change in progression

Copyright @Rakhimoff_Amir

Harvard University questions

General

Preferred start term	Fall 2024
Admission plan	Regular Decision
Preferred residence	On Campus
Financial aid	Yes
Do you intend to submit supplementary materials?	Yes
Consider testing?	I have submitted or will submit SAT or ACT scores, and would like them to be considered as part of my application

Academics

Field of study 1	Psychology
Field of Study 2	Music
On a scale of 1 (absolutely certain) to 5 (very likely to change), how definite do you consider your academic plans to be?	1
On a scale of 1 (absolutely certain) to 5 (very likely to change), how definite do you consider your vocational plans to be?	2
On a scale of 1 (absolutely certain) to 5 (very likely to change), how definite are your extracurricular and/or athletic interests?	1
Are you applying for a program with the New England Conservatory?	No
Are you applying for a program with Berklee College of Music?	Yes

Activities

Activity 1	Cultural Groups
Intended level of participation (sports)	Club/Intramural/Recreational
Activity 2	Orchestra
Intended level of participation (sports)	Club/Intramural/Recreational
Activity 3	Community Service
Intended level of participation (sports)	Club/Intramural/Recreational
Activity 4	Band
Intended level of participation (sports)	Club/Intramural/Recreational
Activity 5	Pre-Professional Groups
Intended level of participation (sports)	Club/Intramural/Recreational

Contacts

Have you previously applied to Harvard?	No
How have you learned about Harvard?	Letter/Mailing
Additional contact	Social Media
Additional contact	Email
Contact Consent	Yes, I consent to be contacted by Harvard University at the mobile phone number provided below.
Phone Number	+1.830-302-6326

Family

Parent different address	No
Is parent 1 living?	Yes
Parent 1 Occupation	Teacher or administrator (elementary)
Parent 1 Employment status	Employed
Parent 1 Position/Title	Music Teacher
Parent 1 Current employer	Comal Independent School District

Is parent 2 living?	Yes
Parent 2 Occupation	College administrator/staff
Parent 2 Employment status	Employed
Parent 2 Position/Title	Senior Lecturer
Parent 2 Current employer	Texas State University
Number of siblings	1
Sibling 1 Education level	Some college/university
Sibling 1 Degree	Bachelor's (BA, BS)
Sibling 1 College name	Robert Lopez
Sibling 1 College start date	08/2022
Sibling 1 College end date	05/2026

Other Information

Have you ever been found responsible for a disciplinary violation at any educational institution? No

Have you ever been convicted of, or pled guilty or no contest to, any felony or misdemeanor? No

U.S. Military Veterans

U.S. Armed Forces No

Short Answers

Life experiences / contribute to Harvard

As a percussionist, navigating the different techniques for every hittable instrument is the basis of my curiosity. At what angle does the tambourine best rattle? What kind of mallet should I use to strike a woodblock? The answers to these questions, I learned, are 45 degrees and rubber. At its

core, drumming is not mindlessly hitting things in hopes of creating noise; rather, the musical mediums of skin, wood, and metal are the elements that I bind together to form both rhythms and melodies.

While I come from a musical background, I've grown to admire the parallels between approaching both instruments and people. Teaching students of my own, specific attention to the different thought processes of each child is required; the tactics I use to teach the exercise "chicken and a roll" vary between kids, much like the differences in technique between the snare drum and the glockenspiel.

Through T.H.U.D., I will continue my musical journey in a transformative environment where diversity is the cornerstone of education. Asking questions is the most crucial component of the human experience- at Harvard, I plan to establish an organization to provide free music education to under-resourced children.

Intellectual experience

Searching through the overflowing drawer of my father's file cabinet labeled "MARIMBA REPERTOIRE," unfamiliar pictographs greeted me with surprise. My father's voice interrupted my staring contest with the yellowing pages speckled with the mystery title- "I know it's Japanese, but I have no clue what it says."

The entire night following my first encounter with Japanese, I locked myself in my room, binging videos like "Learn ALL Kana" promising to teach me the language in under an hour. However, learning a Category V language on the FSI scale, which requires 2200 hours to master, was going to take more than YouTube. After months of immersing myself in Japanese podcasts like "Nihongo con Teppei" and self-studying the three alphabets through textbooks, I no longer needed subtitles for Japanese episodes of Peppa Pig.

Through foreign language, I realized the importance of human interconnectivity. My admiration for linguistics prompts me to give tours to primarily Spanish-speaking students at my school, and I find myself appreciating grammar structures and phonetics of other languages like Mandarin Chinese, which I soon hope to learn. Although I may not consider myself a polyglot just yet, my journey in language learning is far from over.

EC/employment/travel/family experiences

Having been deeply involved in the competitive world of classical music since early childhood, I took a step back from it the summer before my senior year to explore the vibrant realm of mariachi with my father. As a member of the *armonía* (harmony) section, I overcame my dependence on written sheet music through my role as a supporting musician. Since most songs could switch keys depending on the vocal range of the singer, I learned to listen to the natural direction of the bass frequencies to guide me through complex chord progressions instead of hastily memorizing song structures. Having always considered myself a visual learner, this shift to an auditory-focused environment was both challenging and exciting, pushing me to expand my horizons through total immersion.

Pushing forward, I recognize the importance of tuning into people's voices and their accompanying articulations to collaborate with them far beyond the musical realm. Through Mariachi Veritas de Harvard, I hope to contribute my authentic sound as a Mexican-American. I no

longer rely on my eyes to provide me with a sense of direction; rather, my passion for interpreting sound guides me into the uncharted territories of the future.

Education plans

Tuning timpani without a tuner, striking my coffee mug with the spoon each morning, and drumming on every surface, I subconsciously feel the urge to create music; yet, while I pride myself in my musical quirks like perfect pitch, the underlying processes of the auditory cortex in response to external sound stimuli spearhead my attraction to the intersection of music and scientific research.

At Harvard, I hope to deepen my understanding of neural networks and their effects on coordination and tonal perception, facilitating my ability to establish musical methods to delay cognitive degradation through the combination of Harvard's Music major and the Mind, Brain, and Behavior Initiative. More specifically, I plan on conducting music perception research in Professor Max Krasnow's lab to determine the effects of music on the brain structure of people of varying ages and cultural backgrounds, as well as discover an auditory trait that is a significant indicator of a person's likelihood of developing perfect pitch.

Whether I'm touring around the globe with the Harvard-Radcliffe Orchestra or curating new psychotherapy methods to treat dementia, with Harvard's exceptional opportunities tailored to my interests, I'll flourish in the academic and humanitarian expertise that Harvard has to offer.

Roommate intro

I hate dead silence. Headphones feel invasive and gross, so I'll be bringing a speaker for our dorm- I prefer to listen to music in the open while I'm working or lounging around. Whether I'm listening to Bach's *Well-Tempered Clavier* or Mac DeMarco's best hits, I hope you'll jam with me! Of course, I'm open to suggestions- just promise me to not play country music. (I secretly enjoy 80's George Strait, but let's keep that a secret.)

I'm always down for a sweet treat. I like to pair my morning *cafecito* with a *pan dulce* for the most optimal breakfast- but after dinner, my desire for dessert models an exponential function with time on the x-axis.

If you see me flicking random items with my fingers, don't worry! I'm most likely seeking inspiration for a new composition to jot down in my manuscript notebook; after all, I might end up using teacups, rice bowls, or spoons as one of the featured instruments. Music playback software can get annoying; hence, I keep my ideas on paper. A musical motif might be hiding in the scatterbrained heap of pages on my desk, so please don't alley-oop them into the recycling bin.

Affirmations

By submitting this application, I affirm my understanding of and agreement to the statements found here: <http://www.commonapp.org/affirmations>.